

HISTORY HACK • DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Read the following two primary source excerpts and answer the prompt below.

US.36 — Describe changes and limitations in the social and economic status of women during this era, including flappers, birth control, clerical and office jobs, and the rise of women’s colleges.

US.37 — Examine challenges and advancements related to the push for civil liberties, including (T.C.A. § 49-6- 1006): • First Red Scare • Immigration Quota Acts of the 1920s • Resurgence of the Ku Klux Klan • Black Wallstreet and Tulsa Massacre • Rise of the NAACP • Efforts of Ida B. Wells-Barnett • Emergence of Garveyism

US.38 — Describe the Scopes Trial of 1925, including the major figures (i.e., John Scopes, William Jennings Bryan, and Clarence Darrow), two sides of the controversy (i.e., fundamentalism and modernism), the outcome, and the legacy.

TEACHER EDITION — scoring guide and expected evidence. Not for student distribution.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

The sources

Document A

Calvin Coolidge, address to the American Society of Newspaper Editors, Washington, D.C., January 17, 1925 (White House press release / Congressional Record, public domain)

“The chief business of the American people is business. They are profoundly concerned with producing, buying, selling, investing and prospering in the world...Advertising ministers to the spiritual side of trade. It is a great power that has been entrusted to your keeping which charges you with the high responsibility of inspiring and ennobling the commercial motives and ideals of America.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT A

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

Document B

U.S. Senate Banking and Currency Committee Report on the Stock Market Crash, 1931 (U.S. Government Printing Office, public domain)

“The decade of the nineteen-twenties saw a vast increase in the use of credit for the purchase of securities...The very ease with which credit was obtained, the persistently advancing prices of securities, and the large profits made by those who bought on margin all combined to attract new participants into the market...When the collapse came, it came with a completeness and a speed that took even the most experienced observers by surprise.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT B

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

The question

Using BOTH documents and your knowledge of mass media and consumer culture (US.34) and economic prosperity and speculation (US.36), write a multi-paragraph response that applies HIPP to each document and constructs an argument about how the consumer culture promoted in the 1920s created the conditions for economic collapse. Your response must analyze both documents' Historical context, Intended audience, Purpose, and Point of view; explain what each document's perspective reveals about its author's knowledge and interests; and use outside evidence to support your argument.

Plan your answer

Your claim	
------------	--

Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document A		
Document B		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

Scoring guide

Pts	6-point scale
6	Exemplary. Full HIPPA for both documents including Coolidge's limitation (he cannot foresee the crash) and Senate Committee's retrospective advantage. Precise argument linking consumer culture ideology (Doc A) to structural vulnerability (Doc B). At least two pieces of outside evidence. Cross-era connection to Great Depression.
5	Advanced. HIPPA (3+ elements) for both. Clear argument. Both documents cited. At least one piece of outside evidence.
4	Proficient. HIPPA (2+ elements) for both. Argument present. Both documents used.
3	Adequate. Some HIPPA for both. Argument present but underdeveloped.
2	Developing. HIPPA for only one document. Weak argument.
1	Beginning. Summary without HIPPA. No clear argument.
0	No response or completely off-topic.

Expected evidence and document analysis. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS: Coolidge's 'limitation' (no foreknowledge of crash); Senate Committee's retrospective position; both documents produced in very different political contexts. KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: Installment buying, radio/advertising, margin buying, Black Tuesday, Mellon tax policy, Smoot-Hawley, Hoover's response, connection to US.39 Great Depression.

Sourcing. Every document above carries its own citation as written in the item record. Verify each against the holding institution before classroom use — an unsourced primary source is worse than a missing one.

History Hack · TroopToTeacher Technologies. Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28. classroom-formative · pre-field-test — this activity has not been field-tested and its scoring guide is not calibrated.